4b First Aid — Quick Reference

HB6 BLS & First Aid lecture · burns · trauma · anaphylaxis · snake bite

guideline wording — say it aloud DOPS On the examiner's DOPS marking form ☐ tick when done

KEY MESSAGE

Every first aid scenario starts with **DRSABCD** and **call for help (000)**. Then treat the specific problem, reassure, and stay with the person.

BURNS

- ☐ Clothes on fire → **STOP** (reassure) · **DROP** (to ground) · **ROLL** (wrap in blanket, roll until out)
- ☐ DRSABCD; severe burn or **airway burn** → 000
- ☐ **Cool running water 20 minutes**, as soon as possible
- ☐ Remove clothing + jewellery **unless stuck** to the burn
- ☐ Cover loosely with **cling film** or non-stick sterile dressing
- ☐ Check for and treat **shock**; calm and reassure
- ☐ **DON'T:** lotions, ointment, butter/fat or neutralising agents · touch the burn or burst blisters · remove stuck material · touch an **electrical burn** patient until power is safe

MEMORY AID — BURNS — "20 minutes, cool, cover"

Cool running water for **20 minutes**, then cover with cling film. Nothing greasy, nothing popped.

TRAUMA & SEVERE BLEEDING

- ☐ Signs of severe bleeding: **weak, rapid pulse** · pale, cool, moist skin · sweating · rapid gasping breathing · restless · nausea · thirst · dizzy/confused · loss of consciousness
- ☐ DRSABCD (move from danger if safe) · **gloves** · **000** · stay calm, stay with them
- ☐ Find injuries → **stop bleeding** (direct pressure) · **immobilise fractures** · keep **warm** · recovery position
- ☐ **DON'T remove embedded objects** · amputated parts **on ice** · **nothing to eat or drink** · minimise movement · elevate limbs (improves blood return to core in shock)

ANAPHYLAXIS

Mild–moderate	Severe (= anaphylaxis)
Swelling of lips, face, eyes	**Difficult / noisy breathing**
Hives / itchy raised rash	**Swelling of tongue / throat**
Anxious, scared	**Wheeze** → risk of LOC + cardiac arrest

1. DRSABCD
2. **Lay flat** — don't let them stand or walk (sit up only if breathing difficult)
3. Remove allergen if known (flick out sting, wipe food from mouth, stop medication)
4. Follow their **ASCIA Action Plan**; help them self-administer
5. **Adrenaline IM** — EpiPen® or Anapen® into the **outer (lateral) thigh**
6. **000** + family / emergency contact
7. Calm and reassure
8. **Further adrenaline** if no improvement
9. Stops breathing → DRSABCD

MEMORY AID — EPIPEN — "Blue to the sky, orange to the thigh"

Remove blue safety cap → orange end on outer thigh → push until click → hold **3 seconds**. Note the time. Lay flat.

SNAKE BITE

- ☐ Signs: pain, swelling, bruising, bleeding, puncture marks/scratches · tender groin/axillary glands · dizziness, nausea, vomiting, headache, abdo pain · **double/blurred vision, drooping eyelids**, difficulty speaking/swallowing · limb weakness/paralysis · breathing difficulty · collapse then apparent recovery
- ☐ DRSABCD · call for help (000)
- ☐ **Mark the bite site** with pen, cover with tissue (venom ID) — **don't wash it**
- ☐ **Pressure immobilisation bandage**, bandaging **upwards** the whole limb
- ☐ **Splint** the limb; keep person and limb **still**
- ☐ Reassure; stay until help arrives

> **MEMORY AID — SNAKE BITE — "Mark, Wrap, Splint, Still"**
> Mark the site → wrap the whole limb firmly upwards → splint → keep still (movement spreads venom via lymph).

MY NOTES